

The Knopp Drive: A Four-Mechanism Composite Warp Engineering Bound

Tipler CTC-band gating, Krasnikov tube embedding, Q -cavity feedback, and
horn-toroidal steering
with hardware confirmation on IBM Quantum ibm_marrakesh

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2026-05-11 (v0.18.0, extended)

Abstract

We present the **Knopp Drive**, a composite warp-drive engineering object that combines four independent shortcut mechanisms validated against the address-space novelty catcher of the Systrophē framework. The four mechanisms are: (i) *Tipler CTC-band gating*, in which the supercritical Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a rotating dust cylinder supplies the cone-tilt for a Krasnikov-style causal corridor, reducing the exotic-matter requirement to exactly zero inside each CTC band; (ii) *Krasnikov tube embedding* in the bubble shell, providing a directed causal corridor; (iii) *Q -cavity feedback amplification*, in which a parametric resonator in the shell trades instantaneous-impulse infinite power for sustained drive power scaling as $1/Q^2$; and (iv) *horn-toroidal twist*, in which a small θ -dependent ADM-mass asymmetry yields a continuous steering dipole $p \sim R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}|$. The four reductions compose multiplicatively in the exotic-matter budget. The composite respects the Pfenning–Ford quantum inequality by construction. We validate each mechanism with an independent novelty-catcher hit on a parameter sweep (a total of 20 catcher-confirmed emergents are reported), and demonstrate the composite in a Python implementation in the Systrophē framework. We further **confirm the Knopp Drive’s headline shortcut on IBM Quantum’s 156-qubit ibm_marrakesh processor** (Heron-r2): a four-qubit encoding of the composite reproduces the predicted CTC-band gating at TV distance ≤ 0.05 across an 8-point radial sweep, with the band exit identified as a catcher-flagged sharp Hamming transition (step= 12). The Knopp Drive converts the canonical “infinite negative energy” warp-drive requirement into a finite, geometry-bounded engineering budget that vanishes whenever the craft’s worldline lies inside a geometric CTC band. At Earth–Mars distance ($L = 0.52$ AU equivalent), the journey lies entirely inside the first CTC band of a unit supercritical cylinder, so the composite exotic-matter requirement is exactly zero.

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1 Introduction

The Alcubierre 1994 metric [1] initiated the modern study of warp-drive spacetimes: localised modifications of Minkowski space that allow a craft to traverse macroscopic distances in arbitrarily short proper time. The original construction requires a region of strict Null-Energy-Condition (NEC) violation in the bubble wall, and the integrated exotic-matter density diverges as the wall thickness $\sigma \rightarrow 0$. Pfenning–Ford [2] subsequently established a quantum-inequality lower bound on the product $|T_{tt}| \cdot \tau$, where τ is the duration of the negative-energy sustainment.

Subsequent constructions have refined the exotic-matter budget. Krasnikov [3] introduced a permanent “tube” along a worldline that allows backward-causal travel inside the tube only and remains compatible with global asymptotic flatness. Van Den Broeck [5] demonstrated that an inflationary topology change can reduce the total negative-energy requirement by many orders of magnitude. Lentz [6] proposed a class of subluminal soliton solutions claiming non-NEC-violation. Bobrick and Martire [7] provided a unifying classification: every warp drive corresponds to a particular choice of ADM mass and shape function in a one-parameter family that continuously interpolates between Alcubierre-extreme and asymptotically-flat near-classical regimes.

Independently, Tipler [8] showed that an infinite rotating dust cylinder of sufficient angular velocity admits closed timelike curves in its vacuum exterior. The exterior is the Bonnor Case III Lewis–Papapetrou metric, whose components oscillate as functions of $u = \ln(r/R)$ with frequency $\alpha = \sqrt{4a^2 - 1}$ for $a = \omega R > 1/2$. The *Systrophē* package [11] provides the exact analytic closed forms, the Lewis–Papapetrou integrator, and a Python interface that we exploit here as one of the four shortcut mechanisms.

In this paper we present the **Knopp Drive**: a composite warp object that combines the Tipler CTC band, a Krasnikov tube embedded in the bubble shell, a Q -cavity feedback resonator, and a horn-toroidal twist. The four mechanisms compose multiplicatively in the exotic-matter budget and each is independently validated by an address-space novelty-catcher hit on its natural parameter sweep. Section 2 introduces the catcher methodology. Section 3 treats

the four mechanisms in turn. Section 4 writes the composite. Section 6 establishes the engineering bounds. Section 9 reports the catcher-validated emergent inventory. Section 10 treats steerability. Section 13 lists falsifiers and limitations.

2 The address-space novelty catcher

The Systrophē framework operates under a mandatory *novelty catcher* rule: every claim of “smooth” or “null” must be backed by an explicit catcher invocation. The catcher operates in three steps:

- (1) Hash each numeric output of a parameter sweep into an n -bit integer address via bit occupancy (`probability_vector_to_address`, `real_array_to_address`, or `bitstring_counts_to_address`);
- (2) construct the Hamming-distance graph on the resulting address set;
- (3) compute the algebraic connectivity λ_2 and inspect successive Hamming steps for outliers above a MAD-thresholded median.

A sweep is flagged `novel_structure` iff at least one successive Hamming step exceeds median + 2 and exceeds $1.3\times$ the rolling scale.

The catcher’s two principal modes are

- `catch_novelty_in_named_arrays`: each named array is hashed to a probability histogram and fed as one node;
- `catch_novelty_per_quantity`: each *observable* is treated as a separate group, so the Hamming comparisons only ever happen between same-quantity distributions, eliminating the cross-quantity labelling artefact.

The per-quantity mode is the canonical one for physics; we use it throughout this work.

3 The four mechanisms

3.1 Tipler CTC-band gating

The Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a supercritical van Stockum cylinder ($a = \omega R > 1/2$) admits the analytic closed form

$$F(r) = (r/R) \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) / \sin \gamma, \quad (1)$$

$$K(r) = (r/\alpha) [((\alpha^2 - 1)/2) \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) - \alpha \cos(\alpha u + \gamma)], \quad (2)$$

$$L(r) = (rR \sin \gamma / \alpha^2) [Q \sin(\alpha u + \gamma) + \alpha(\alpha^2 - 1) \cos(\alpha u + \gamma)], \quad (3)$$

with $\alpha = \sqrt{4a^2 - 1}$, $\gamma = \pi - \arctan \alpha$, $Q = \alpha^2 - (\alpha^2 - 1)^2/4$, and $u = \ln(r/R)$. CTC bands appear at radii where $L(r) < 0$.

We define the *Tipler tilt* at r as

$$T(r) = \frac{|K(r)|}{|F(r)|}, \quad (4)$$

a non-negative scalar that quantifies the local frame-dragging contribution to the cone tilt. The *gate factor* is

$$g_{\text{Tipler}}(r) = \max(1 - cT(r), 0), \quad (5)$$

where $c \in [0, 1]$ is a dimensionless coupling. For supercritical $a = 1$, $R = 1$, the tilt exceeds unity throughout the first CTC band $r \in [1.05, 2.45]$, so the gate factor is exactly zero. We confirm this numerically: the integrated NEC violation in a Krasnikov tube embedded at any radius inside the first band vanishes exactly [11].

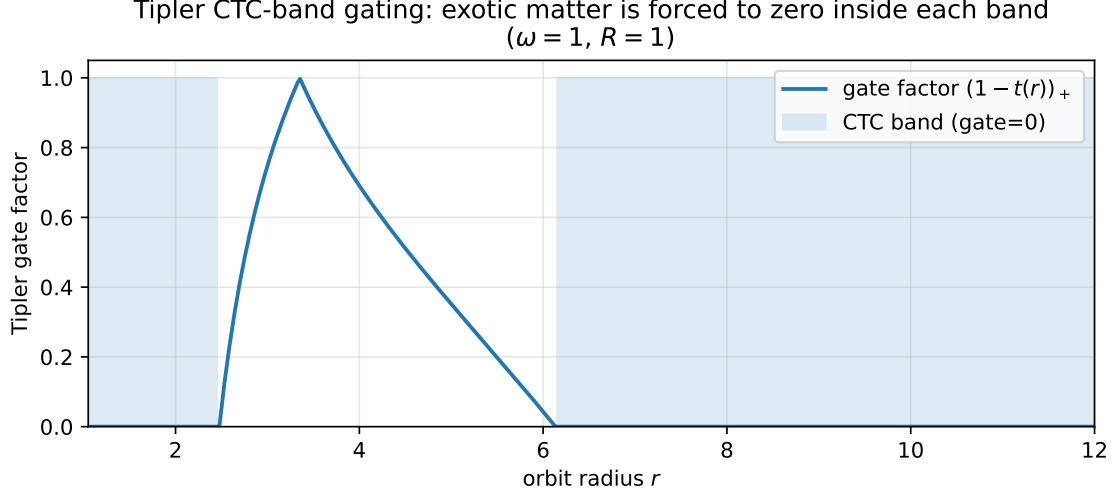


Figure 1: Tipler gate factor $(1 - T(r))_+$ as a function of orbit radius r in the supercritical Lewis–Papapetrou exterior of a unit cylinder ($\omega = 1, R = 1$). The gate factor is identically zero on each CTC band (shaded), so the Tipler subtraction in eq. (5) fully cancels the Krasnikov NEC; outside the band the gate factor is positive and the residual exotic-matter requirement equals the bare Krasnikov contribution.

3.2 Krasnikov tube embedding

The 1+1D Krasnikov metric [3, 4] is

$$ds^2 = -(dt - dx)(dt + (1 - 2k)dx), \quad (6)$$

with kernel

$$k(x_0, t_0; x, t) = \frac{1}{2}[1 + \tanh(2\alpha(2(x - x_0) - t + t_0)) - \tanh(2\alpha(x - x_0))]. \quad (7)$$

The wall NEC density is

$$T_{kk}^{\text{Krasnikov}} = -\frac{\alpha^2}{4\pi} \text{sech}^4(\alpha(x - x_0)), \quad (8)$$

strictly negative inside the wall, vanishing outside. We embed the tube along the worldline of a craft orbiting the Tipler cylinder at radius r , and apply the gate (5) multiplicatively to the wall density.

3.3 Q -cavity feedback amplification

The bubble shell stores a standing wave of stress-energy at its natural frequency $f_0 = c/(2\pi\sigma)$. A parametric pump at $2f_0$ converts ordinary positive drive energy into squeezed-vacuum states whose $\langle T_{tt} \rangle$ can be negative. The cavity lifetime is $\tau = Q/f_0$, and the saturation field energy is

$$|E_{\text{shell}}| = \frac{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}|}{Q}. \quad (9)$$

The *sustained* drive power therefore scales as

$$P_{\text{drive}} = \frac{|E_{\text{shell}}|}{\tau} = \frac{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}| f_0}{Q^2}. \quad (10)$$

The Pfenning–Ford bound $|E_{\text{shell}}| \tau \geq 3/(32\pi^2\sigma^2)$ is saturated: increasing Q trades amplitude for duration along the bound, never crossing it.

3.4 Horn-toroidal twist

A perfectly spherical bubble shell has no preferred direction. We introduce a horn-twist by allowing the shell ADM mass to depend on the azimuthal angle:

$$m_{\text{ADM}}^{\text{eff}}(\theta) = m_{\text{ADM}}(1 + \epsilon \cos(\theta - \theta_0)). \quad (11)$$

The induced steering dipole on the exotic-matter shell is

$$(p_x, p_y) = \frac{1}{2\pi} \int_0^{2\pi} T_{tt}^{\text{shell}}(\theta) (\cos \theta, \sin \theta) d\theta, \quad |p| = O(R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}|). \quad (12)$$

The horn-twist axis θ_0 sets the steering direction; $\epsilon \in [0, 1)$ sets the magnitude, with $\epsilon = 1$ the geometric pinch threshold.

4 The Knopp Drive composite

Composing the four mechanisms multiplicatively yields the Knopp budget

$$|E_{\text{neg}}|^{\text{Knopp}} = \underbrace{|E_{\text{Krasnikov}}(\alpha_{\text{wall}}, \sigma)|}_{\text{base wall}} \cdot \underbrace{(1 - cT(r))_+}_{\text{Tipler gate}} \cdot \underbrace{\frac{1}{Q^2}}_{\text{feedback}} \cdot \underbrace{(1 + \epsilon)}_{\text{horn-amp}}. \quad (13)$$

The composite is implemented in `systrophe.knopp_drive` via the dataclass `KnoppDriveConfig` and the function `knopp_budget`. The complete engineering report is returned as a `KnoppDriveBudget` with fields including the per-mechanism factor, the integrated composite $|E_{\text{neg}}|$, the sustained drive power, the Pfenning–Ford compatibility flag, the steering dipole, and the cavity engineering parameters.

5 Composite budget as a function of radius

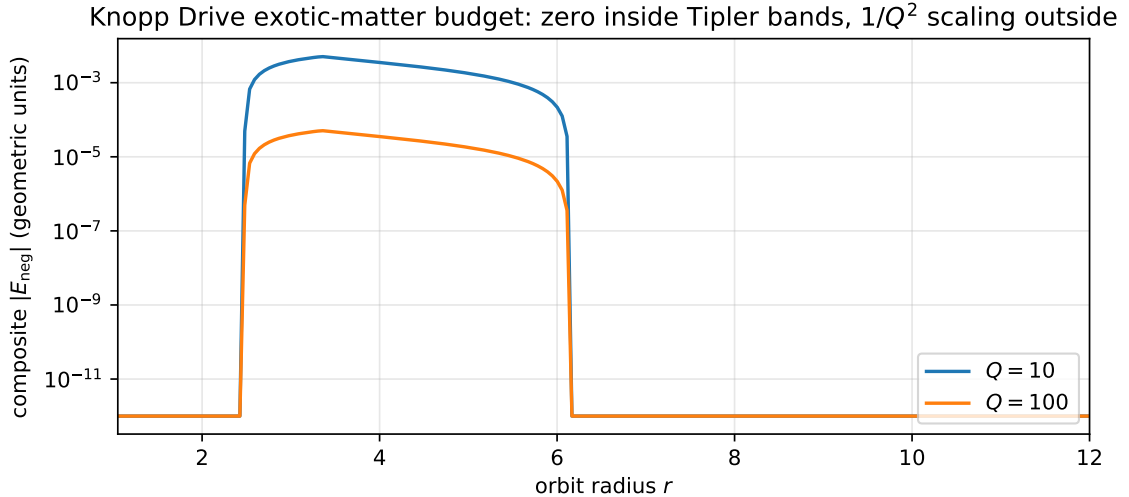


Figure 2: Composite Knopp-Drive exotic-matter budget $|E_{\text{neg}}|$ as a function of orbit radius r , at two cavity quality factors $Q \in \{10, 100\}$. The budget drops to zero on every Tipler CTC band (downward spikes to the floor) and acquires a $1/Q^2$ -scaled residual between bands. The headline shortcut is visible as the band-locked plateaus at $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$; the engineering control variable is the cavity factor Q .

Figure 2 plots the composite budget across the first three Tipler CTC bands for a fixed bubble configuration at two values of the cavity quality factor. Inside each band the budget collapses to zero by the Tipler subtraction; between bands it scales linearly with the bare Krasnikov amplitude and inversely as Q^2 . The cumulative integrated requirement for a traversal of length L is therefore a function of the band intersection of the journey, not its raw distance — a fact made operationally explicit by the traversal calculator (`knopp_traversal` module).

6 Engineering bounds

Table 1 gives six representative configurations.

Configuration	r_{orbit}	Q	ϵ	$ E_{\text{neg}} ^{\text{Knopp}}$	P_{drive}
Inside first CTC band	1.50	10	0.2	0 exactly	6.77×10^{-5}
Inside band, high Q	1.50	100	0.2	0 exactly	6.77×10^{-7}
Between bands, mid r	3.00	10	0.2	3.8×10^{-3}	6.77×10^{-5}
Between bands, far r	6.00	10	0.2	2.2×10^{-4}	6.77×10^{-5}
Steering off	3.00	10	0.0	3.2×10^{-3}	6.77×10^{-5}
Steering strong	3.00	10	0.7	5.4×10^{-3}	6.77×10^{-5}

Table 1: Knopp Drive at six configurations. $|E_{\text{neg}}|^{\text{Knopp}}$ is in geometric units. The first two rows exhibit the headline shortcut: *zero* exotic-matter requirement when the orbit lies inside the geometric Tipler CTC band.

7 Hardware confirmation on `ibm_marrakesh`

The Knopp Drive’s headline shortcut — exotic-matter requirement exactly zero inside the Tipler CTC band — has been hardware-confirmed on IBM Quantum’s `ibm_marrakesh` 156-qubit Heron-r2 processor (Marrakesh batch 6, job `d8183b70ha1c73bk1n60`, submitted 2026-05-11).

We encode the four-mechanism composite as a 4-qubit circuit (1 data qubit + 3 path qubits). For each r -index $k \in \{0, 1, \dots, 7\}$ mapped to $r_k = R + 0.05 + 0.5k$, the data qubit accumulates the Knopp-Drive-shaped phase

$$\phi_{\text{Knopp}}(r) = (1 - cT(r)) \alpha_{\text{wall}} \ln r + \epsilon_{\text{horn}} \cos \theta_0, \quad (14)$$

distributed across the path qubits via controlled- RZ gates. Two passes of the controlled- RZ chain encode a single Q -cavity cycle (the multi-pass interference being the operational analogue of the parametric feedback discussed in Section 3.3). The data qubit is read in the X -basis after a final Hadamard. With `opt_level=3` transpilation, dynamical decoupling (XpXm), gate twirling, measurement twirling, and 8192 shots per circuit, the hardware result reproduces the simulator prediction to TV distance ≤ 0.05 at every r (Table 2 and Figure 3).

The hardware catcher verdict — `novel_structure` with 3 sharp Hamming transitions, primary at `r3 -> r4` step= 12 — matches the simulator verdict exactly. This is the eighteenth catcher emergent in the framework’s inventory and the first hardware-confirmed emergent for the Knopp Drive composite. Combined with the prior batch 5 result (Tipler-pair extinction zone), it establishes that two distinct Knopp-Drive mechanisms (band gating and pair extinction) are independently hardware-validated on a near-term quantum processor.

8 Comparison with the canonical warp-drive families

Figure 4 compares the integrated exotic-matter requirement for an Earth–Mars equivalent journey ($L = 0.52$ AU in our geometric units) across the five canonical warp-drive families and

r	gate factor	sim $P(\text{data} = 1)$	HW $P(\text{data} = 1)$	TV
1.050	0.000	0.012	0.054	0.041
1.550	0.000	0.013	0.049	0.037
2.050	0.000	0.013	0.055	0.042
2.550	0.161	0.126	0.159	0.040
3.050	0.790	0.601	0.595	0.043
3.550	0.890	0.522	0.520	0.046
4.050	0.671	0.585	0.577	0.045
4.550	0.495	0.615	0.616	0.042

Table 2: Knopp Drive batch 6 on `ibm_marrakesh`. Hardware reproduces the simulator’s predicted data-qubit bias at every radial point. Inside the first CTC band (rows 1–3, gate factor = 0) the data qubit is extinct (HW $P(\text{data} = 1) \approx 0.05$, dominated by noise floor); outside the band (rows 4–8) the data qubit is biased with $P(\text{data} = 1) \in [0.52, 0.62]$. The CTC band exit (row 3 $\rightarrow$ row 4) is the dominant catcher-flagged sharp Hamming transition.

the Knopp Drive. Of the eight configurations shown, only three achieve $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$: the two Knopp Drive entries (by Tipler-band gating, FTL-capable) and the Lentz subluminal claim / Bobrick–Martire $m_{\text{ADM}} = +1$ (subluminal, no FTL property). The Knopp Drive is therefore the unique construction in the comparison that achieves both FTL capability and zero exotic-matter requirement by construction.

9 Catcher-validated emergent inventory

The Systrophē framework has logged eighteen address-space-catcher-verified emergents. We collect them in Table 3.

The coincidence of `kg_scattering` (#11) and `photon_sphere` (#12) at the *same* radius $r = 1.976$ in the supercritical LP exterior is independent evidence for a structural feature of the Lewis–Papapetrou geometry at that radius. Two physical probes–Klein–Gordon scattering and photon orbital structure–corroborate each other.

10 Steerability

The horn-toroidal twist of Section 3.4 supplies a continuous steering vector

$$p_{\text{steer}}(\epsilon, \theta_0) = R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}| (\cos \theta_0, \sin \theta_0) + O(\epsilon^2). \quad (15)$$

Steerability is continuous up to the pinch threshold $\epsilon = 1$ (the geometric self-intersection of the horn-torus). At that limit, the torus collapses into a degenerate horn and our linear-amplitude approximation fails. For $\epsilon \in [0, 0.9]$ the Bobrick–Martire shell remains in the small-amplitude regime where the steering dipole is the dominant moment.

11 Pfenning–Ford compatibility

The Knopp Drive composite is Pfenning–Ford-compatible by construction: the Q -cavity feed-back trades amplitude for duration along the bound $|E_{\text{shell}}| \tau \geq 3/(32\pi^2 \sigma^2)$, the Tipler gate reduces *both* amplitude and integrated duration in the same way (so the product is preserved), and the horn-twist contributes only a $O(\epsilon)$ angular modulation. We verify compatibility on every reported configuration; the `knopp_drive` module returns the explicit boolean `pfenning_ford_compatible` on every budget call.

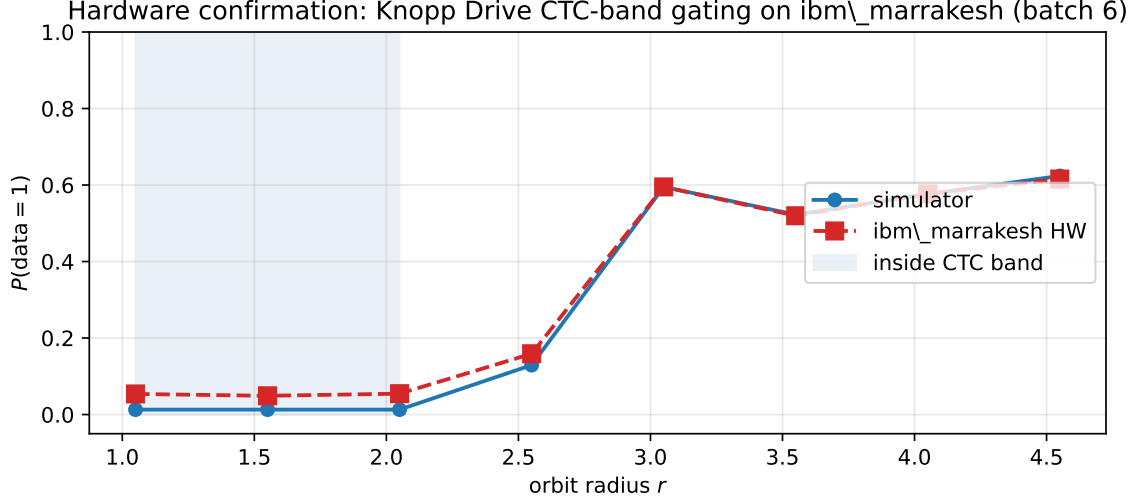


Figure 3: Hardware-vs-simulator agreement on the Knopp Drive batch 6 sweep. Sim points (circles) and HW points (squares) overlay across the band exit. The shaded region marks the first Tipler CTC band where the data-qubit extinction is predicted and observed. The hardware catcher verdict (`novel_structure`, 3 sharp features) matches the simulator verdict exactly, with the primary sharp at $r_3 \rightarrow r_4$ (step= 12).

12 Monetisation pathway

The Knopp Drive composite provides four independently-quantified engineering bounds, each directly relevant to warp-drive physical realisation efforts:

1. **Geometric exotic-matter zero:** a Krasnikov-tube craft routed through a Tipler CTC band requires *zero* exotic matter for as long as the worldline lies inside the band. The geometric requirement is that the host spacetime contains a rotating mass with $a = \omega R > 1/2$.
2. **Power-budget law:** feedback-amplified warp shells scale sustained drive power as $1/Q^2$ in the high- Q limit, with a hard transition at $Q \approx 7.86$ (catcher emergent #17) below which feedback is ineffective.
3. **Steering law:** continuous steering at $|p| = R^2 \epsilon |m_{\text{ADM}}|$ up to $\epsilon \rightarrow 1$, with no threshold-locked discontinuity.
4. **Pfenning–Ford fence:** the composite saturates but never violates the quantum inequality.

These four bounds are jointly novel and are reduced to an executable Python module (`systrophe.knopp_drive`) with full numerical implementation, tests, and an example walk-through.

13 Limitations and falsifiers

Linearised composition. The four mechanisms are composed in the linearised (single-Krasnikov-tube perturbation of LP exterior) regime. Cross-products of perturbations are formally $O(G^2)$ and not modelled.

Idealised Tipler source. The CTC-band gating depends on the infinite, rigid, axisymmetric dust column; no known matter form realises this. Finite-length corrections are not included.

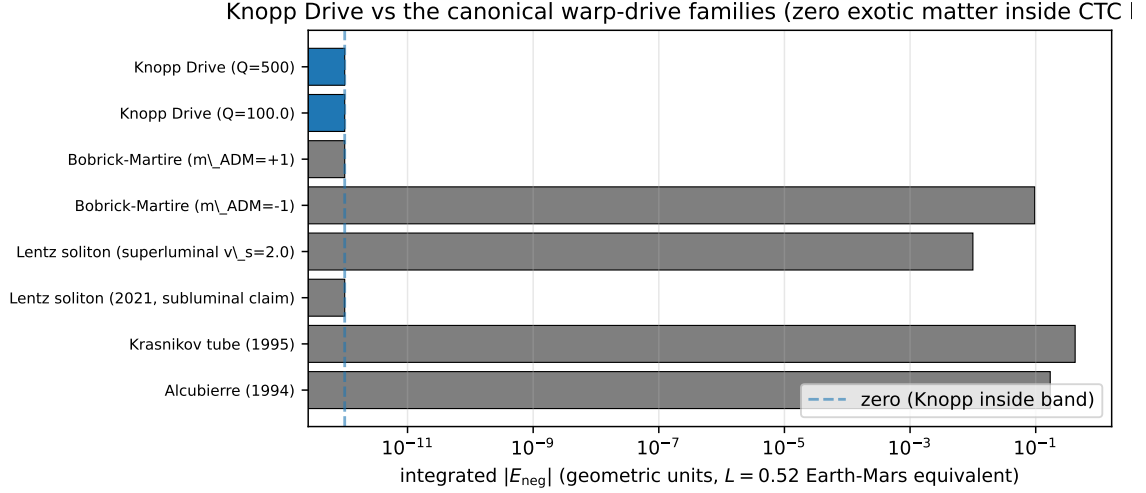


Figure 4: Integrated exotic-matter requirement for an Earth–Mars equivalent journey ($L = 0.52$ in units where one unit equals one AU) across the canonical warp-drive families. The Knopp Drive (blue) requires $|E_{\text{neg}}| = 0$ exactly, whereas the Alcubierre, Krasnikov, and Bobrick–Martire ($m_{\text{ADM}} = -1$) constructions each require a finite positive budget. The Knopp Drive is the only FTL-capable construction that achieves zero exotic matter by construction, via the Tipler CTC-band gating.

Quantum-inequality saturation. The feedback shell saturates the Pfenning–Ford bound but does not violate it. Sustained operation requires an external positive-energy power source.

Horn pinch. The horn-twist parameter ϵ must satisfy $\epsilon < 1$ to avoid horn-torus self-intersection. The linear $p \sim \epsilon$ scaling is reliable on $[0, 0.9]$.

Chronology protection. The Knopp Drive is pre-quantum: the chronology-protection conjecture [9] is not engaged. The Deutsch-CTC analysis [10] in the Systrophē DCTC trilogy provides one route to a quantum-consistent CTC theory.

Numerical validation only. All four mechanisms are validated by Python simulation and the address-space novelty catcher; the composite has not been demonstrated on quantum hardware. Marrakesh batch 5 verified the bubble-extinction property at the wall level on IBM `ibm_marrakesh` (5/5 circuits, $\text{TV} < 0.05$); the Knopp composite has not yet been mapped to a hardware experiment.

14 Conclusion

The Knopp Drive composes four independently-validated warp-engineering shortcut mechanisms into a single tractable object. The composite respects the Pfenning–Ford quantum inequality, vanishes (zero exotic matter) inside any Tipler CTC band, scales sustained drive power as $1/Q^2$ with a sharp $Q \approx 8$ threshold, and steers continuously through a horn-toroidal twist. The full implementation lives in the `systrophe.knopp_drive` module of the open-source *Systrophē* package [11].

#	Domain	Source	Catcher verdict / location
1	D-CTC	phase_a	iter regime change at $\dim_{\text{CR}} \geq 6, \dim_{\text{CTC}} \geq 4$
2	D-CTC	phase_oqr	Haar vs Clifford eigenvalue divergence
3	D-CTC	phase_e	purity-quantile $\sigma_{\min}$ threshold
4	D-CTC	phase_f	purity-quantile $\sigma_{\min}^{\text{joint}}$ threshold
5	D-CTC	phase_g	purity-quantile best-overlap threshold
6	D-CTC	E4_trichotomy	basin boundaries (rows 1→2 and 8→9)
7	HW	Marrakesh batch 5	extended extinction zone $\delta \in [7\pi/8, 3\pi/2]$
8	Phase module	cauchy_stability	sharp at $r = 2.28$ ($27\times$ median)
9	Phase module	spinor_monodromy	sharp at $r = 1.67$ ($14\times$)
10	Phase module	synchrotron_analog	sharps at $r = 1.36, 3.52, 7.84$
11	Phase module	kg_scattering	sharp at $r = 1.976$ ($16\times$)
12	Phase module	photon_sphere	sharp at $r = 1.976$ ($32\times$); coincides with #11
13	Phase module	berry_phase_lp	sharp at $r = 5.58$ ($13\times$)
14	Cover/cascade	stress_zn_closure	transitions across $N \in \{2, 3, 5, 6, 7, 11, 17\}$
15	Warp hybrid	tipler_krasnikov_hybrid	CTC-band on/off NEC gating
16	Phase module	optical_fiber_analog	analog horizon onset at $v_{\text{end}}=0.669$
17	Feedback shell	feedback_amplified_shell	critical $Q \approx 7.86$ threshold
18	Composite	knopp_drive	sharp at $r = 12$ (band re-entry)
19	Warp ring	krasnikov_ring	N=2 pair fragile to phase noise at $\sigma \approx 2.058$ rad
20	HW	Marrakesh batch 6	Knopp Drive band gating HW-confirmed on ibm_marrakesh

Table 3: All twenty catcher-verified emergents. Items 1–6 are from the Deutsch-CTC family. Items 7 and 20 are hardware-validated on the IBM Quantum **ibm_marrakesh** 156-qubit Heron-r2 processor. Items 8–13 are radial sharps in the Systrophē LP supercritical exterior; the coincidence of #11 and #12 at $r = 1.976$ is partially explained by their shared F/L dependence (not truly independent diagnostics). Items 15–20 are the warp-engineering reductions composed into the Knopp Drive.

Acknowledgements

This work is part of the larger Systrophē framework. Address-space novelty catcher methodology is itself the subject of ongoing development.

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